

BEST WC PERFORMANCE CHAMPION (1973, 1993, 2009, 2017)

ICC RANKING: **2nd**

STRENGTHS

England boasts enviable batting depth, with Heather Knight's return adding experience and stability alongside Nat Sciver-Brunt in the middle order. Danni Wyatt-Hodge's inclusion provides further firepower at the top. The spin attack, anchored by world no. 1 Sophie Ecclestone and supported by Charlie Dean, Sarah Glenn, and Linsey Smith, is another major asset in subcontinental conditions.

WEAKNESSES

England has often struggled with resilience. When momentum shifts, the side tends to lose collective focus, as seen in its white-ball capitulation at home against India in June-July. The bowling can appear short of ideas under pressure, while the batting leans too heavily on Sciver-Brunt, who has yet to find consistent authority as captain.

OPPORTUNITIES

This tournament offers a platform for England's emerging players — Em Arlett, Lauren Bell, and Sophia Dunkley, among them — to ease the transition from veteran dependence. After finishing runner-up in 2022, the side has the chance to prove it can remain a contender even while in flux. With 15 wins from 24 ODIs in this cycle, England has shown it can remain competitive even amid change. The World Cup offers a chance to consolidate that base and convert promise into consistency.

THREATS

The Charlotte Edwards era is still in its formative stage, and the team has shown vulnerability when unsettled early. Opponents are likely to target Ecclestone and Sciver-Brunt, England's twin pillars; if either is neutralised, the squad's balance and confidence could quickly unravel.

PREDICTION

More than England losing competitive ground, other teams have caught up in form, consistency, and squad balance. For a coach who collects trophies for fun, this World Cup will be the biggest test of whether Edwards' magic can make a difference. England should fancy making the knockouts, but it won't be easy.

Lavanya Lakshmi Narayanan

CAPTAIN
NATALIE SCIVER-BRUNT

COACH
CHARLOTTE EDWARDS

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